TUESDAY 19 JANUARY 2027 · SAN FRANCISCO

Something in the air.

EARF makes hi-fi and light in cast acrylic, tinted all the way through, in eight colours. On 19 January the first pair of Tropos, our horn loudspeaker, plays for the first time, in an eight-week listening room in San Francisco that opens that night. We are looking for three partners to make the night, and the weeks after it, theirs as much as ours: a hotel, a drinks brand, and a record label or shop.



THE NIGHT

Tue 19 Jan 2027

The pop-up's opening; [time], [venue]

THE WEEK

SF Art Week

16–24 Jan; FOG Design+Art at Fort Mason, 21–24 Jan

THE ROOM

Eight weeks

Thursday to Sunday, 1 to 8 pm, to mid-March; catered nights on Fridays

THE GUESTS

48 organisations

Design galleries, studios, hi-fi, records, hospitality; and the press

PICTURES ARE RENDERS: ON THE NIGHT, THE REAL THING

One night, eight weeks, and the first pictures that aren't renders.

Who will be in the room

Collectors and dealers in town for FOG Design+Art: galleries from its 2027 list (Marta, Patrick Parrish, Hostler Burrows, Gallery FUMI and others). San Francisco's design studios and showrooms. The city's hi-fi shops and listening bars. Record labels and shops. Hotel and hospitality groups. And the design, city and hi-fi press, briefed for a spring launch.

What every partner gets

- Named on the printed invitation and the email (both drafted)
- A Session of its own: one album, start to finish, in the listening room, under its name
- Its product in the room, all eight weeks, where the guests are
- Named in the spring press release and the fact sheet
- Use of the night's photographs and the teaser film
- A first conversation about an edition in one of the eight colours (est.; nothing promised)

A HOTEL

Near Fort Mason, Union Square or Jackson Square

- Rooms for visiting guests and press in FOG week
- A room for the after-hours Session, or the pop-up's AV
- Later: a listening suite, fitted by EARF

`Ask: $5k–15k cash, or rooms and space in kind (est. value $3k–10k)`

A DRINKS BRAND

Spirits, or non-alcoholic

- The night's drinks, named, through a licensed caterer
- A drink for each tint, Ember to Smoke
- Its bottles on the bar for the catered Fridays

`Ask: product and bartending in kind (est. value $2k–8k), or cash, structured with counsel`

A RECORD LABEL OR SHOP

Bay Area first

- The room's records, chosen with them
- A selector or artist set on the night
- The first Session, possibly recorded and pressed (EARF Sessions)

`Ask: records, an artist set and a Session in kind; or $5k toward the pressing`

The timeline

WHEN	WHAT
By mid-December	Partners agreed; names and logos for the invitation
Week of 4 January	Invitations out, to the 48 organisations and the press; the partner named on each
Tuesday 19 January	The opening: the first pair plays; the partner's drinks, records and Session; photographs
16–24 January	SF Art Week; FOG Design+Art at Fort Mason, 21–24 January; the room open to the fair's visitors
To mid-March	Thursday to Sunday, 1 to 8 pm; catered Fridays; the partner's product in the room throughout
22–29 March	The spring press release, with the partners named

Drinks and the law. California's tied-house rules bar alcohol makers and wholesalers from furnishing money or things of value to on-sale licensees, with narrow exceptions (B&P §25500). Any spirits partnership is structured with counsel, and drinks on the night are served through a licensed caterer (the pop-up's plan uses Type 58 caterer nights). A non-alcoholic partner avoids the question.

Who we'd ask first, and why.

PARTNER	WHY IT FITS	PUBLIC CONTACT ROUTE (SEEN 31 OCT 2026)
HOTELS		
The Battery Jackson Square	A members' club and hotel whose members are the city's creative and tech crowd: Planet EARF's buyers, two streets from the galleries	press@thebatterysf.com
Palihotel San Francisco Union Square	A design-driven group: lamps in its lobby, a listening corner, rooms for FOG guests	events@palihotelsf.com; info@palisociety.com
Hotel Emblem Union Square	A Beat-generation hotel with an arts programme: a natural home for a Session	sales@hotelemblem.com
San Francisco Proper Mid-Market	Design-led (Kelly Wearstler); its group's press notes a feature on hotels for music lovers	Press through its agency, proper@autumncommunications.com
DRINKS		
St. George Spirits Alameda	The Bay's own distillery, with private and public events of its own. Its page says it is not taking donation requests: pitch as marketing, not a gift	Contact form (Marketing, Private event); stgeorgespirits.com/contact
Ghia non-alcoholic aperitif	Design-led, colour-saturated, non-alcoholic: no tied-house question, and a drink for each tint	partnerships@drinkghia.com
The New Bar alcohol-free shop	An alcohol-free shop that runs events and partnerships; a whole zero-proof list for the room	Contact form (Events & partnerships); press@thenewbar.com
Seedlip non-alcoholic spirits	The category's best-known name; a clean, no-alcohol night	Contact form (Trade inquiry) on seedlipdrinks.com
RECORDS		
Stranded Records + Superior Viaduct Mission and Oakland	A curated shop and its reissue label: the room's crates and a Session on a new release	info@strandedrecords.com; press@superiorviaduct.com
Dark Entries Records San Francisco	The city's defining archival label, with a DJ following: a selector set for the night	Contact form on its Bandcamp page
Light in the Attic Seattle and LA	A reissue label whose catalogue suits a listening session, start to finish	press@lightintheattic.net
Craft Recordings (Fantasy's catalogue)	Bay Area jazz history and audiophile reissues: a Session that sounds like the speakers	info@craftrecordings.com

Nothing has been sent; no one has been contacted. Routes were seen on each organisation's own site on 31 October 2026; re-check before writing. The pitch for each type is drafted in money/PARTNERS.md.